

THE DOCTOR IS IN

Prescription By Nutrition

EP 101

Ketogenic Diets Are More Than A Fad.



MARTIN  CLINIC

Dr. Martin Jr.: Hello, my name is Dr. Tony Martin Jr.

Dr. Martin Sr.: And I'm Dr. Tony Martin Sr.

Dr. Martin Jr.: This is, The Doctor Is In podcast. In fact this is episode 101, so a 101 episodes of ... you know, we've been doing this for a while.

Dr. Martin Sr.: Yep.

Dr. Martin Jr.: We've enjoyed the first hundred, and we're going to enjoy the next hundred. If you're new to our podcast, we have a lot of information, and a lot of old podcasts that you can go listen [00:00:30] to. We're very thankful that you're listening to us. We're glad-

Dr. Martin Sr.: Much appreciated.

Dr. Martin Jr.: Yeah, we're glad you're along for this ride. Today, let's talk about a couple of new studies that were just released within the last few weeks. Now, we're recording this podcast in the month of September, 2-17, so these are studies that came out in August, and early September of 2-17, so, we'll talk about those.

Dr. Martin Sr.: They're brand new.

Dr. Martin Jr.: They're brand new. They talking about the fad [00:01:00] that won't go away, which is ketogenic diets. We've been talking about ketogenic diets for a long time. It's something that we've been using in our clinic for a long, long time. We wrote our first book about that years ago, called The Serial Killer Diet, we have a brand new program, weight loss program called The Serial Killer Revisited Program, where a lot of people have gone through the program, lost a lot of weight, they fix [00:01:30] a lot of health issues, so we've talked about ketogenic diets, and supposedly this was just a fad, it was going to go away, but it's picking up steam, because in research they have, if you look at the amount of participants in a research, in the study, they're called the N number and there's an N equals whatever.

Ketogenic diets, there's a lot of N equals ones. There's a lot of people's testimonies that are saying, "Hey, look at this thing, this way of eating has changed my life." So, today we're going to talk about those two studies, and then [00:02:00] we'll also talk about, what exactly is a ketogenic diet? What exactly does that mean? How do you get into ketogenic diet? We'll talk about that.

Dr. Martin Sr.: And the reason it works.

Dr. Martin Jr.: And the reason it works. Yeah. We'll talk about that. First, let's talk. Well, maybe before we even talk about the studies, let's just talk a little bit about what a ketogenic diet is in the first place. If I were to ask you to explain to me [00:02:30] what a ketogenic diet is-

Dr. Martin Sr.: Well, I always give a simple explanation in my office, right? I love the kiss method. Keep it simple stupid, because I'm a simple guy. I just always tell people that. I'm the cause and effect guy. I want to keep

things simple for me, and don't complicate life for nothing. I like to explain it to my patients, because the word doctor, means teacher. You ought to be teaching your patients. [00:03:00] Gone are the days, we talked about this in our 100th podcast, about the days of Latin and me, doctor, don't ask questions.

People are way beyond that today. People want to know. People get on the internet, and I love the internet for a lot of reasons. There's some stuff on the internet that's stupid, but generally people are smart, and my patients are very, very, our patients are very smart.

Dr. Martin Jr.: Yes, they're well educated, and they understand their body.

Dr. Martin Sr.: [00:03:30] They know more about nutrition than their family doctor does.

Dr. Martin Jr.: Yes, and that's why they get frustrated when their family doctor-

Dr. Martin Sr.: They know more about cholesterol than their family doctor does. That drives me crazy, but anyway. If you want to know, here's the simple explanation I give about the ketonic diet. What is ketosis? Your body has two gas tanks, right? You're either burning carbs as fuel, or you're burning fat [00:04:00] as fuel. Your body works in two ways. It functions with two types of fuel, carbs and fat. If you cut your carbs down-

Dr. Martin Jr.: Before you go any further, let's just talk about what it's like to live on a carb based fuel tank, and what that looks like. Let's talk about that really quickly, because that's interesting. That's a great [00:04:30] analogy that you're either going to burn carbs for energy, or you're going to burn fat for energy. Now, we function best when our body is burning fat for energy. Carbs are not the greatest source of energy. They're a great source of quick energy, but they burn off quickly, or if you can't use it right away, you end up storing it, right? A carb fueled person, has to eat a lot. They need carbs before [00:05:00] activities, during activities, after activities. They have to constantly be carbing up in a sense, right?

Dr. Martin Sr.: I use the wood stove analogy. Your metabolism is running like a wood stove. Paper and twigs are carbs. You're not going to heat your house with that. It gets the fire started. Ketones are fat burning, because that's all [00:05:30] it means, fatty acids are burning, as fuel. Ketones are just logs on the fire. Those are simple illustrations.

Dr. Martin Jr.: But that's good.

Dr. Martin Sr.: Like you say, a carb is, it's bang. You get it, it burns. If you don't burn it, it goes into storage. It goes into storage. It's turned into fat.

Dr. Martin Jr.: One of the problems that people have today is we consume too much energy in a sense, [00:06:00] right?

Dr. Martin Sr.: We don't need all that.

Dr. Martin Jr.: We don't need it, so we have to store it. We've got to put it somewhere, so we store it in fat cells.

Dr. Martin Sr.: Liver, liver, liver suitcase.

Dr. Martin Jr.: A fat adopted person, or somebody who's burning fat for energy, they're basically, a lot of times what ends up happening is they're taking their own fat cells. They're breaking down their own fat cells. That's the thing, fat cells are really stored energy. That's all it is. Basically, it's carbohydrates that's been converted [00:06:30] and basically stored into fat. Fat cells. There's a fancy word called lipolysis, which is just basically, a way of saying the breakdown of fat for energy. So, when you are in lipolysis, you are basically burning fat for energy. That's a good thing, and when you're not in lipolysis, you're basically storing fat. You're storing, sorry, carbohydrates into fat cells. So, you want to be in lipolysis. You want to be burning fat for energy, [00:07:00] and carbs essentially stop that from happening.

When you are fat adopted, you are tapping into your fat cells for energy. You just feel better. Your energy is more consistent. That's basically an airplane view of the difference that goes on when somebody is burning fat for energy, versus somebody burning carbohydrates for energy.

The next question then, would be this, how do you switch [00:07:30] over from being a carb burning person, to somebody who burns fat for energy? How does that happen? Is there a magic number? How does that happen?

Dr. Martin Sr.: It's such a good question, but I always tell people, "Look, the world's changed, right? We don't eat like we use to eat. I say the number all the time, because the numbers don't [00:08:00] come from me. The numbers come from the government, right? The stats can or the American Government. They give out what people are eating." So, 160 - 180 pounds of sugar a year, because the food industry denatured food. What they did is they took fat out of food, from cereal to pancakes, to yogurt, to milk, to whatever. What did they do? They took the fat out of it, and what did they do? They added sugar to it. You can't buy [00:08:30] a yogurt today, well most yogurts.

Dr. Martin Jr.: Yeah, they're hard to find.

Dr. Martin Sr.: They're denatured. Like yogurt is sour milk, so what did they do? They said, "well, fat makes you fat, so we'll take the fat out of it, and we put sugar in it." Because high fructose-

Dr. Martin Jr.: So, whata?

Dr. Martin Sr.: Why are we burning so many carbohydrates? Because we're eating so many carbohydrates. The world's changed. I saw it happen in my own practice. I've been in practice 43 years, and what have I seen? The change is we're carbaholics. [00:09:00] We eat 160 pounds of sugar, 160 pounds of flour.

Dr. Martin Jr.: Well, you know, and it's interesting. Even if you analyze the diets over the years, one of the things you see is that people are getting a massive percentage of their calories from carbohydrates now, right? Now, the standard American diet, they call it the sad diet, because it is sad. They're consuming 50% above [00:09:30] carbohydrates. For 50%, 55%, 60% of their calories are carbohydrate based. The sad thing is that's how kids eat. Kids are even higher than that.

Dr. Martin Sr.: The world today, it's a pet peeve of mine, because a lot of people will talk about when I'm a vegan, or a vegetarian.

Dr. Martin Jr.: We don't care. You're right. One of the problems with that is that [00:10:00] they end up eating way too many carbohydrates.

Dr. Martin Sr.: Way, way, way too many carbohydrates, because they're not, that analogy of logs on the fire, they're very deficient in my analysis of their diet. I do an analysis on it.

Dr. Martin Jr.: A lot of times, and you see this all the time, you analyze people's diets. A lot of vegetarians, they eat a lot of processed foods. I mean, they get a lot of their energy intake in a day from [00:10:30] eating a lot of carb based stuff. We've talked about this off the air before, but even if you look at, for example, somebody who is gluten intolerant, and there's so many people today that have, either they have celiac or non-celiac gluten sensitivity, but the reality is they switch to a different ... Rather than if you're having a hard time with gluten going and eating more real foods, [00:11:00] they end up eating a lot of these-

Dr. Martin Sr.: ... engineered foods with food coloring.

Dr. Martin Jr.: Yeah, food coloring junk on top of it, right?

Dr. Martin Sr.: And they just load them up with sugar.

Dr. Martin Jr.: Some of the worst food that you can buy are gluten free. There are still some people that we meet, that think that gluten free food is healthier. We tell people, "You're just going to get gluten free diabetes." I mean, there's no difference. You're going to get it. It's unhealthy food. You're right. One of the things that's happened today, is people are definitely [00:11:30] consuming way more carbohydrates than before. We talk about this as well. Low carb is a spectrum. It can mean a lot of different things for a lot of different people. Medicine will define low carb as basically even around 30% of your calories from carbohydrates. For some people that could be 170 grams of carbs a day, but when somebody use to be eating 500 grams of carbs, or 350 [00:12:00] grams of carbs a day, that is definitely low carb diet to what they're used to.

Dr. Martin Sr.: Yeah.

Dr. Martin Jr.: But okay, let's get back to the ketogenics. Generally, we see people become fat burning. They get into ketosis. They're burning ketones for energy, when they get under that 50 grams of carbohydrates a day. Now, what's also interesting is that if somebody is really insulin resistant, they've got to be eating [00:12:30] less than that. They can't get into

ketosis with even 50 grams of carbs. Their body way overreacts. They produce insulin for a long time, and they can't quite get into ketosis, so they have to go down even less than that. Some have to go under 30 grams. Some have to go under 20 grams. It just depends on, it's very different. Some can get into ketosis eating 50 grams, no problem, right?

The bottom line is though, they enter into ketosis, meaning they're burning ketones for energy, meaning they're using fat for energy, [00:13:00] right?

Dr. Martin Sr.: Rocket fuel. It's so much better for you.

Dr. Martin Jr.: Yeah, it's better for your brain. There were these myths before, that your brain needed so many grams of carbs. Your brain functions on sugar, but they found that's not true. Your body makes carbs. Your body makes what it needs. It can either get it right away from food, or your body will make it. That's the bottom line. So, that's I guess, an easy way, or kind of a quick summary of what a ketogenic diet, [00:13:30] and they're big now. A lot of people are talking ketogenic diets, right?

Dr. Martin Sr.: Yeah.

Dr. Martin Jr.: And a lot of people, and let me say this as well, because this is something that we see a lot. Just because somebody is in ketosis, it doesn't mean they're going to lose weight. We talk about that in our Serial Killer Revisited Program, why that is. Just because somebody is burning ketosis for energy, does not mean that they're going to be losing weight.

Dr. Martin Sr.: Yeah. Well, there's other factors, right?

Dr. Martin Jr.: They'll be healthy. [00:14:00] In a sense, they're getting the benefits of the ketones.

Dr. Martin Sr.: And they're lowering their inflammatory markers, and they're doing a lot of good things by eating that way, right?

Dr. Martin Jr.: But a ketonic diet does not mean weight loss. It doesn't mean that at all. For a lot of people it does, but some people will struggle on that, but there are ways around that also, that they're doing wrong.

So, let's talk about those two studies that came out, because we've talked about this off air. There were relatively big studies that were done. The first one [00:14:30] was done, and this one was interesting. They found that a ketogenic diet, basically reduced mortality, and preserves memory in aging male mice. So, this was a big study done on mice, and they found that the ketonic diet basically preserved their memory, and it helped them live longer.

What I found interesting about this study myself, was [00:15:00] that this was an every other week ketogenic diet. So, they weren't on ketosis full time. It was what they call a cyclical ketogenic diet. They were on and off of ketosis, right? Which goes to show you, that just doing it. Even if you can't do it all the time, still has some benefits.

Dr. Martin Sr.: Yeah, big benefits. Your cells love it by the way. Your body cells love when you're burning fat. It's a much better fuel. I tell people it's like [00:15:30] turbo fuel, right? Rocket fuel for the body. It's a tremendous, tremendous burning fuel.

Dr. Martin Jr.: So again, here's another study that shows that eating a ketogenic diet is basically going to help you live longer, and have a better brain. I'm going to read you a quote from somebody here on these studies. So, it says, "Two independent studies published today in the Journal [00:16:00] of Cell Metabolism raises the hope that ketogenic diets, if followed, do more than just slim waists." Because a lot of people-

Dr. Martin Sr.: Yeah, that's why they do it, right?

Dr. Martin Jr.: That's the reason why people will-

Dr. Martin Sr.: That's their motivation, right?

Dr. Martin Jr.: Yup. It's definitely that. They also appear to improve the odds of living longer, and remembering better, because let's be honest, there are a lot of people who may be living longer, but their brains aren't living as long as their body is.

Dr. Martin Sr.: Yeah, they outlive their brain. Why would you [00:16:30] want to do that?

Dr. Martin Jr.: The idea here is that, not only does it increase lifespan, but it also increases the lifespan of your brain. Then he says, "but these were studied in Amos." But then he goes on to say, "the same effects have yet to be proven in humans, and plans for that are in the works, but in the meantime, self experimenting and bio-hackers are collecting antidotal evidence all around the world." And we [00:17:00] see that all the time, right?

Dr. Martin Sr.: Yeah.

Dr. Martin Jr.: That's what we see in our clinic all the time. People's brains are getting better. They're healthier.

Dr. Martin Sr.: All their markers for metabolic syndrome get better.

Dr. Martin Jr.: Yeah.

Dr. Martin Sr.: I mean it's amazing, right? I mean the proof's in the pudding. I always show patients before and after, all their markers that they improve.

Dr. Martin Jr.: It probably is the number one thing you can do for your health, and the nice thing is that the studies are showing that you don't have to be doing it all the time, [00:17:30] because that's one of the things that we hear. "Oh, I gotta do this for the rest of my life." But if they can incorporate it into their lifestyle, where they do this for a period of time. We see this a lot that people that do that, generally on the days where they're not in ketosis, they're still not consuming nearly as many carbs as they were before, so they're still eating a low carb diet.

Dr. Martin Sr.: Yeah, and sugar. Right. Yup.

Dr. Martin Jr.: We consider anything to be a low carb diet. [00:18:00] Anything that's less than the amount of carbs that you were store in your liver. If you can never fill up your liver, we consider that, you and I off air, that's what we would consider a low carb diet. So, that's anywhere between roughly about 120 grams of carbs and under. Some people 150 depending on the person. Anything under that would be, by today's standard, considered a low carb diet, but the reality is, is that [00:18:30] I can't think of anything that you can do for your health besides incorporating some form of a ketogenic plan. It doesn't have to be full-time. Some need it longer than others. Diabetics, they've got to fix some-

Dr. Martin Sr.: Cancer.

Dr. Martin Jr.: Cancer. They've got to definitely do that, but there's not a person that wouldn't benefit from some kind of cyclical ketogenic plan. Every other week. A couple days a week.

Dr. Martin Sr.: [00:19:00] That's why the serial killers have been so popular too.

Dr. Martin Jr.: Yeah, that program that we developed is a cyclical ketogenic program, so that it's a, it really combines the best of both worlds. We developed something we call The Carb Window. It's an amount of time that you can eat carbs in a week, and still get the effects of a ketogenic diet. It's something that you've used in the clinic forever. If you were to start listing all the [00:19:30] testimonials, it would take us forever to go through that. You see the results every day.

I guess the point of this episode here would be, if you haven't incorporated a ketogenic lifestyle at all, you're missing the benefits of what it can do for your health, what it will do for your brain, and what it will do for a quality of life. That's something that you definitely should be looking into.

[00:20:00] So, we want to thank you for listening to this episode. Again, if you're listening on iTunes, if you can go on there and just leave us a real quick review, that would be super beneficial for us, and we would really appreciate it if you just leave us a quick, honest review. Because that again, allows Apple to show it to more people. That's how they kind of work their algorithm, and we really think the information that we provide will benefit a lot of people, so we just want to get as many people to hear this [00:20:30] as possible.

So again, if you haven't left us a review, we would like that very much, and if you have any questions, you can email us at info@martinclinic.com. We answer a lot of emails and we have tremendous staff, health coaches that are well trained that are there to answer questions. So, we would love to hear from you as well. Again, thank you for listening, and have a great day.

